

HOMOSALATE

_____ Name
_____ Date

also called... homomethyl salicylate, homomenthyl salicylate, or 3,3,5-trimethylcyclohexyl salicylate.

What is it?

Homosalate is an ultraviolet absorbing agent used as a sunscreen in various cosmetic products.

Where might it be found?

sunscreen
tanning oil
sunless tanner
facial moisturizer
cream or lotion
make-up foundation
powder
blush, bronzer
lip balm
lipstick, lip gloss
nail polish
shampoo
conditioner
hair styling gel, mousse

Cross reactivity: Individuals who are allergic to homosalate should *also avoid* contact with the related chemical octisalate, also known as octyl salicylate.

How to avoid it:

Avoid using any product that contains **homosalate** or one of the names highlighted above. It is important to check the complete ingredient list on the label of each product you use. If homosalate is present, one of its names should appear in the ingredients.

If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or at websites such as <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

For possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list of each product you encounter. Use protective gloves if necessary.

Be sure to tell your beautician, hairdresser, masseuse, barber, attendant, and others who are involved in your personal care about your allergy. If you must come in contact with homosalate during the care of your children, elders, or pets, wear protective gloves made of rubber or vinyl.

By reading ingredient labels, you should be able to avoid this allergen and find safe substitutes that are free of it. Choose sun protective agents from other families, such as oxybenzone, sulisobenzene, avobenzone, cinnamates (octinoxate), anthranilates (meradimate), ecamsule, octocrylene, zinc oxide, and titanium dioxide.